

FILTER

USER GUIDE

V1.4.1 - BLENDER 4.2+

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FILTER is a Blender extension for fast visibility control and modifier management. The panel lays the scene out by object type, collection and name: any type can be hidden, excluded from render or locked against selection in one click. A separate By Modifier block manages modifiers in bulk - find every Bevel in the scene, select the objects carrying them, apply or remove - with safe bake ordering and a mismatch detector.

github.com/abyrvalg379/FILTER

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1. ABOUT FILTER

Key features:

- visibility, selection and locking by object type: Mesh, Armature, Empty, Light, Camera;
- solo eye: show only the selected type or collection, hide everything else;
- render eye: exclude a type or collection from render without touching the viewport;
- name pattern filter (case-insensitive) and collection filter;
- By Modifier: bulk apply, remove and select across modifier groups;
- settings mismatch detector inside a modifier group;
- order-safe apply: stack order is preserved, baking runs only when required;
- linked-library objects are skipped, linked duplicates handled cleanly.

2. INSTALLATION

- Blender 4.2+: download filter.zip from the latest release github.com/abyrvalg379/FILTER - Preferences - Get Extensions - Install from Disk - pick the zip.
- Blender 3.0-4.1: same zip, via Preferences - Add-ons - Install.
- The panel appears in the 3D viewport N-panel (N key) - FILTER tab.

3. QUICK START

Two typical passes:

- Clean viewport: in the By Type block press the solo eye (Shift + click) on the Mesh row - only geometry remains; armatures, empties and lights hide away. Another Shift + click restores everything.
- Bulk apply: By Modifier block - pick a group (e.g. Bevel) - Apply. If the modifier is not first in the stack, FILTER offers to bake the modifiers above it - the result on every object matches the viewport exactly.

4. BY TYPE

The block lays objects out by five types. Each type has its own buttons:

BUTTON	ACTION
Toggle (eye)	hide/show every object of the type in the viewport
Select	select all objects of the type
Render (camera)	exclude/return the type in render, viewport untouched
Lock	lock/unlock selection for the type
Solo (Shift + click the eye)	show only this type, hide the rest; press again to restore

The states do not conflict: you can keep lights hidden in the viewport yet rendering - the render eye and the viewport eye are independent.

5. BY NAME AND COLLECTIONS

5.1 By Name

Type a name pattern (case-insensitive) - Toggle hides or shows the matches, Select selects them. Handy for serial suffixes: `_geo`, `_low`, `LOD*`.

5.2 Collections

The block lists scene collections with the same visibility, selection and render buttons. Collection visibility runs through the outliner channels - what FILTER hides is honestly hidden in the outliner too, and the other way around.

6. BY MODIFIER

The block gathers scene modifiers grouped by exact name or by type (group switch). The Scene / Selected scope limits the search: the whole scene or selected objects only.

6.1 Operations

OPERATION	WHAT IT DOES
Select	select every object carrying a modifier of the group
Apply	apply the group modifier on all matched objects with order-safe semantics
Remove	remove the group modifier from all matched objects
Remove disabled	one click removes every viewport-disabled modifier in scope
Select different	find and select objects whose group modifier has different settings

6.2 Order-safe apply

If the applied modifier is not first in the stack, the result depends on what sits above it. FILTER resolves this correctly: modifiers above the target are baked top-down first, and only then the target is applied - the result on each object matches the viewport exactly. A confirmation dialog appears only when baking is actually required.

6.3 Special cases

- linked duplicates (Alt+D) sharing a mesh datablock are made single-user automatically before apply;
- linked-library objects are skipped - foreign data is never modified;
- the mismatch detector: a line like "3 with different settings" means some modifiers of the group differ in parameters - Select different marks them for review.

7. WORKFLOWS

Clean model screenshot

Solo eye on Mesh - armatures, empties and service objects vanish. Took the shot - Shift + click brings the scene back.

Deliver a modifier-free model

By Modifier - the Bevel group (or all by type) - Apply with bake confirmation. Run the mismatch detector to make sure nothing drifted, and Remove disabled just in case.

Render without armatures and empties

Render eye on Armature and Empty: the viewport stays as is, but the frame is clean.

Reading a foreign scene

Lock the types you must not touch (Armature), filter by the `_geo` name - and you work only with what you need.

8. TROUBLESHOOTING

SYMPTOM	CAUSE	WHAT TO DO
Apply shows a dialog	the modifier is not first in the stack - the ones above must be baked	confirm: the result stays exactly as in the viewport; skipping the bake breaks the order
Some objects were skipped on apply	linked-library objects or multi-user data	linked duplicates become single-user automatically; linked objects are edited in their own library
Collection visibility "does not apply"	the collection channel is off in the outliner	it is a single state: check the collection eye in the outliner - FILTER and the outliner are in sync
The name filter finds nothing	case or stray characters in the pattern	the filter is case-insensitive; check the pattern (wildcards like <code>*</code> are supported)
Object hidden but visible on render	the viewport eye and the render eye are independent states	to exclude from render use the render eye (camera icon)